DR. XIAOWEI CHEN

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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy, Germany *November 2025 - Present*
Postdoctoral Researcher
Human-Centered Security and Privacy Group
Supervisors: Dr. Yixin Zou and Dr. Thorsten Holz

Research Topic:
I lead the research project "Supporting Infrastructure for Cybercrime Victims" (SiCV), aiming to thoroughly examine the recovery process of cybercrime victims in EU states and to design social and technical supporting infrastructures to aid their recovery. I work with key stakeholders from service platforms, law enforcement, and financial institutions to address the challenges posed by emerging cybercrimes.

University of Luxembourg, Luxembourg *January 2022 - October 2025*
Doctoral & **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Department of Behavioral and Cognitive Science, FHSE
Supervisor: Professor Dr. Christine Schiltz

Research Topic:
I led the "Achieve Effective and Sustainable Anti-Phishing Solutions" project (AES anti-phishing). I secured funding through the Young Academics Open Call (IAS at the University of Luxembourg). In my dissertation, I explored how motivation theories can guide the design of security and privacy interventions, how user experience shapes engagement, and how field experiments can ground these insights in practice. Outputs include multiple A* publications (CHI, CCS) and ongoing collaborations with non-academic stakeholders.

EDUCATION

The University of Luxembourg, Luxembourg *January 2022 - September 2025*
- PhD in Psychology (Human-Computer Interaction) ; Department of Behavioral and Cognitive Science
- Supervisor: Professor Dr. Christine Schiltz
- Dissertation topic: *An Interdisciplinary Approach to Improve Security and Privacy Intervention Design: Motivation Theories, User Experience, and Field Experiments*

Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy, Germany *April 2025 - September 2025*
- Academic guest
- Host: Dr. Yixin Zou (the Human-Centered Security and Privacy group)

ETH Zürich, Switzerland *March 2024 - May 2024*
- Visiting PhD student
- Host: Professor Dr. Verena Zimmermann (the Security, Privacy, and Society research group)

KTH Royal Institute of Technology, Sweden *September 2019 - June 2021*
- Media management MSc; Department of Human Centered Technology
- Supervisor: Professor Dr. Anders Hedman
- Dissertation topic: *Does Persuasive Technology Make Smartphones More Addictive?- An Empirical Study of Chinese University Students*

Katholieke Universiteit Leuven (KU Leuven), Belgium *September 2020 - June 2021*
- Erasmus+ exchange student; Faculty of Economics and Business

Northeast Agricultural University (NAU), China *September 2006 - July 2012*
- Bachelor of Arts in Journalism; Faculty of Humanities and Arts

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Stockholm Dual Career Network, Sweden *October 2018 - November 2019*
Management Team Member: Plan, coordinate and deliver SDCN's social events and workshops.

Grand Continental Vacations, Australia *November 2017 - June 2018*
Tour Operator: Coordinate tours for customers. Collect, evaluate, and respond to customers' feedback.

Ctrip.com, Australia *June 2017 - November 2017*
Business Development Manager: Assist hotels to maintain Channel Managers (Hotel Booking Systems). Tackle IT problems and urgent issues.

F.I.T. Travel, Australia *January 2017 – May 2017*
Travel Consultant: Support online customers via web account, Email, and phone. Collect feedback for tour suppliers and improve the customer experience.

Old Kumara Gold Mining, New Zealand *June 2016 – October 2016*
Manager Secretary: Ensure the implementation of management decisions. Research equipment and suppliers, liaise with excavator suppliers, and prepare reports on supply chain options.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Best Paper Honorable Mention** Awards from ACM CHI '26, ACM CHI '25.
- **Excellent PhD Thesis Award**, University of Luxembourg, academic year 2025.
- Research Support Grants, Doctoral School in Humanities and Social Sciences (DSHSS), University of Luxembourg, 2024 & 2025.
- Travel Grant (for Academic Guest), Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy, 2025.
- **Young Academic Grant**, the Institute for Advanced Studies, University of Luxembourg, 2021.
- The Karl Engvers Foundation scholarship for degree project, Sweden, 2021.
- Erasmus+ Scholarship, the European Commission, 2020.
- The Second Prize Scholarship, NAU, China, 2007.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Program Committee

· Conference on Sociotechnical Cybersecurity and Privacy (SCP '26)
· Workshop on Human-Targeted Cyber Threats and Defenses (HumSec '26)
· The Annual Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK 2026 & 2025)
· The European Symposium on Usable Security (EuroUSEC '25)

Associate Chair

· *Full paper track* of ACM CHI '27
· *User Experience & Usability* Subcommittee of ACM CHI '26

Session Chair

· *Social Impact and Responsible Tech* session at ACM CHI '26

Reviewer

- Distinguished reviewer board member of *ACM Transactions on Computer-Human Interaction*
- Journal of Cybersecurity (2026)
- The 34th European Conference on Information Systems (ECIS 2026)
- ACM DIS '26, CHI '25, CSCW '25, and NordiCHI '24
- 20th International Conference on Wirtschaftsinformatik (WI '25)
- Computers in Human Behavior (2023)

SKILLS

Computer Skills
Python, R Programming, SPSS
LaTeX, TextMaker, Final Cut Pro
Research Methods
Longitudinal field experiments
Surveys, interviews, mixed-methods analysis

Language Skills
English (Professional), Chinese (Native)
Swedish (A1), German (Beginner)

TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

Lecturer for "Introduction to Human-Computer Interaction" Winter/2022

- I have experience independently designing, delivering, and assessing undergraduate teaching in Computer Science, with a focus on User Experience design and persuasive technology. I have coordinated course modules, developed assessments, and supervised Master's students on research- and design-oriented projects.

Co-Lecturer for "Empirical IT Security Research" Winter/2026

- I design, deliver, and assess graduate teaching in Computer Science, with a focus on Quantitative Research methods and Synthesis of Knowledge modules. I coordinate the course teaching with three colleagues, develop assessments, and supervise Master's students on course projects.

Supervision

- **Ramya Kandula**, KTH Royal Institute of Technology & Ruhr University Bochum.
  Master's thesis: *A Research Through Design Approach to Mitigate Filter Bubble Effects on Social Media*.
  Doctoral dissertation project: *Explore the application of LLM-enhanced Chatbot for Social Support*
- **Soham Banerjee**, IIT Kharagpur.
  Doctoral dissertation project: *Platform Switching among Crypto Scams: An Investigation into Chainabuse Reports*

REFEREES

Professor Dr. Verena Distler
Aalto University
Email: verena.distler@aalto.fi

Professor Dr. Verena Zimmermann
ETH Zürich
Email: verena.zimmermann@gess.ethz.ch

Faculty member Dr. Yixin Zou
Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy
Email: yixin.zou@mpi-sp.org

Scientific Director Professor Dr. Thorsten Holz
Max Planck Institute for Security and Privacy
Email: thorsten.holz@mpi-sp.org

LIST OF PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Conference Papers[1]

12. Zhiqing Guo, Lixin Jia, Luning Sun, **Xiaowei Chen**, Guofeng Yu, Liejun Wang, Gaobo Yang, David Stillwell, Thorsten Holz, Shujun Li. From GAN-Based Models to GPT-5: A Taxonomy-Guided Study of Human Performance in Detecting Deepfake Face Images. *To appear* in the IEEE Symposium on Security & Privacy (S&P 2027). May, 2027. (A* CORE Ranking).
11. **Xiaowei Chen**, Mindy Tran, Yue Deng, Bhupendra Acharya and Yixin Zou. 2026. From Harm to Healing: Understanding Individual Resilience after Cybercrimes. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '26), April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM. (A*).
10. Yue Deng, **Xiaowei Chen**, Junxiang Liao, Bo Li and Yixin Zou. 2026. Experiencer, Helper, or Observer: Online Fraud Intervention for Older Adults Through a Role-based Simulation Approach. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '26), April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM. (A*).
9. **Xiaowei Chen**, Verena Distler, Chloe Gordon, Yaxing Yao, and Ziwen Teuber. 2025. Empowering Parents to Support Children's Online Security and Privacy: Findings from a Randomized Controlled Trial. In *Proceedings of the ACM SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security* (CCS '25), October 13–17, 2025, Taipei, Taiwan. ACM. (A*)
8. **Xiaowei Chen**, Lorin Schöni, Verena Distler, and Verena Zimmermann. 2025. Beyond Deterrence: A Systematic Review of the Role of Autonomous Motivation in Organizational Security Behavior Studies. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '25), April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM. (A*)
7. **Xiaowei Chen**, Sophie Doublet, Anastasia Sergeeva, Gabriele Lenzini, Vincent Koenig, and Verena Distler. 2024. What Motivates and Discourages Employees in Phishing Interventions: An Exploration of Expectancy-Value Theory. In *Twentieth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security* (SOUPS 2024). USENIX Association. (A)
6. **Xiaowei Chen**, Margault Sacre, Gabriele Lenzini, Samuel Greiff, Verena Distler, and Anastasia Sergeeva. 2024. The Effects of Group Discussion and Role-playing Training on Self-efficacy, Support-seeking, and Reporting Phishing Emails: Evidence from a Mixed-design Experiment. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '24), May 11–16, 2024, Honolulu, HI, USA. ACM. (A*)
5. Ziming Wang, Yiqian Wu, Shiwei Yang, **Xiaowei Chen**, Björn Rohles, and Morten Fjeld. 2024. Exploring Intended Functions of Indoor Flying Robots Interacting With Humans in Proximity. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (CHI '24), May 11–16, 2024, Honolulu, HI, USA. ACM. (A*)
4. **Xiaowei Chen**, Sophie Doublet, and Verena Distler. 2024. Making Motivation Theories Accessible: Introducing Motivation Cards to Map Motivators for Security and Privacy Education. In *S&PEI Workshop of the Twentieth Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security*.

Journal Papers Note: † indicate co-first author

3. Marianne Junger, Paweł Olber, Rafał Płocki, Hans Luyten, Luka Koning, Caitlyn N. Muniz, Jan Willem Bullee, Victoria Wang, Reinhardt Botha, C. Jordan Howell, Verena Distler, **Xiaowei Chen**, Hiep Cong-Pham, Mohammed Aljohani, Newman U. Richards, Fabian Muhly, Abhishta Abhishta, Steven Furnell. Relationships between cultural orientations, phishing victimization, and phishing recognition: a cross-cultural experiment. *Computers & Security (2026)* (SJR Q1)
2. Anna Metreveli†, **Xiaowei Chen**†, Anders Hedman, and Anastasia Sergeeva. "Who will be left behind?": A Swedish case of learning AI in vocational education. *International Journal of Educational Research* 133 (2025): 102697. (SJR Q1)

[1] In Human-Computer Interaction and Computer Science, top-tier conferences are considered A-ranked venues with prestige and impact equal to that of leading journals.

1. **Xiaowei Chen**, Anders Hedman, Verena Distler, and Vincent Koenig. 2023. Do persuasive designs make smartphones more addictive?-A mixed-methods study on Chinese university students. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, 10, 100299. (SJR Q1)

Papers under Review

* Soham Banerjee, **Xiaowei Chen**, Yixin Zou, Mainack Mondal."Then She Wanted to Move over to WhatsApp": Understanding Platform Switching in Cryptocurrency Scams. *Under review*.
* Mindy Tran, Agata Stanczyk, **Xiaowei Chen**, Isabell Holthaus, Xinru Tang, Veelasha Moonsamy, Kavous Salehzadeh Niksirat, Yixin Zou. Co-Designing Privacy, Safety, and Security Advice with and for Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing People. *Under review*.
* Yongqi Guan, Yuqi Xu, **Xiaowei Chen**, Yunlong Mao, Wei Tong, Sheng Zhong, Xiaobo Zhou, Yixin Zou, and Kanye Ye Wang. Understanding User Practices Against Phishing in the Web3 Ecosystem. *Under review*.